BUILDER, STEP 16

# Same fact, 4 setups. Only 2 knew it in the next session.

Our test of auto memory and a wiki that Claude Code writes itself.

OUR TEST

# Tell it once. Ask in a new session.

| SETUP | NEW SESSION |
| --- | --- |
| Auto memory on | Knew it. 6 seconds |
| Auto memory off | Did not know |
| Wiki, edit not approved | Did not know |
| Wiki, with a yes | Knew it. 8 seconds |

The fact: Sarah wants every invoice in Dutch, sent to finance@example.com, not to her. It was in no file. Made-up client, one run per setup.

TWO KINDS OF MEMORY

# You write CLAUDE.md. Claude writes auto memory.

```
~/.claude/projects/<project>/memory/
  MEMORY.md    # the index, 1 line per memory
  example-logistics-invoicing.md

Why: Sarah's own request (2026-10-28).
```

Anthropic: auto memory "is on by default in local sessions". The first 200 lines or 25KB of MEMORY.md load in every session.

Type /memory to see what it saved.

THE TRAP

# A "remember this" can be lost.

- → Our house rules said: the wiki is the knowledge base.
- → So Claude wanted to write the fact in the wiki, not in its own memory.
- → In manual mode, Claude asks before each edit. Nobody said yes.
- → Nothing was saved. The next session did not know.

After "remember this", read the answer. If it asks, say yes.

THE WIKI

# Karpathy's idea: Claude writes the wiki, you read it.

| LAYER | IN OUR TEST |
|---|---|
| Raw notes | 16 made-up client notes. Never changed |
| Wiki | 9 files: a page per client, 3 topics, index.md, log.md |
| Rules | A 19-line CLAUDE.md |

The price changed from EUR 1,850 to EUR 1,950. The wiki put both prices with their dates under "Current state", and two offers under "Not agreed".

Build: 72 seconds, one time.

THE HONEST RESULT

# With 16 notes, you do not need a wiki yet.

| QUESTION | NO WIKI | WIKI |
|---|---|---|
| The agreed price | 22 s, 10 s | **6 s, 9 s** |
| No October check | 18 s, 16 s | **12 s, 10 s** |

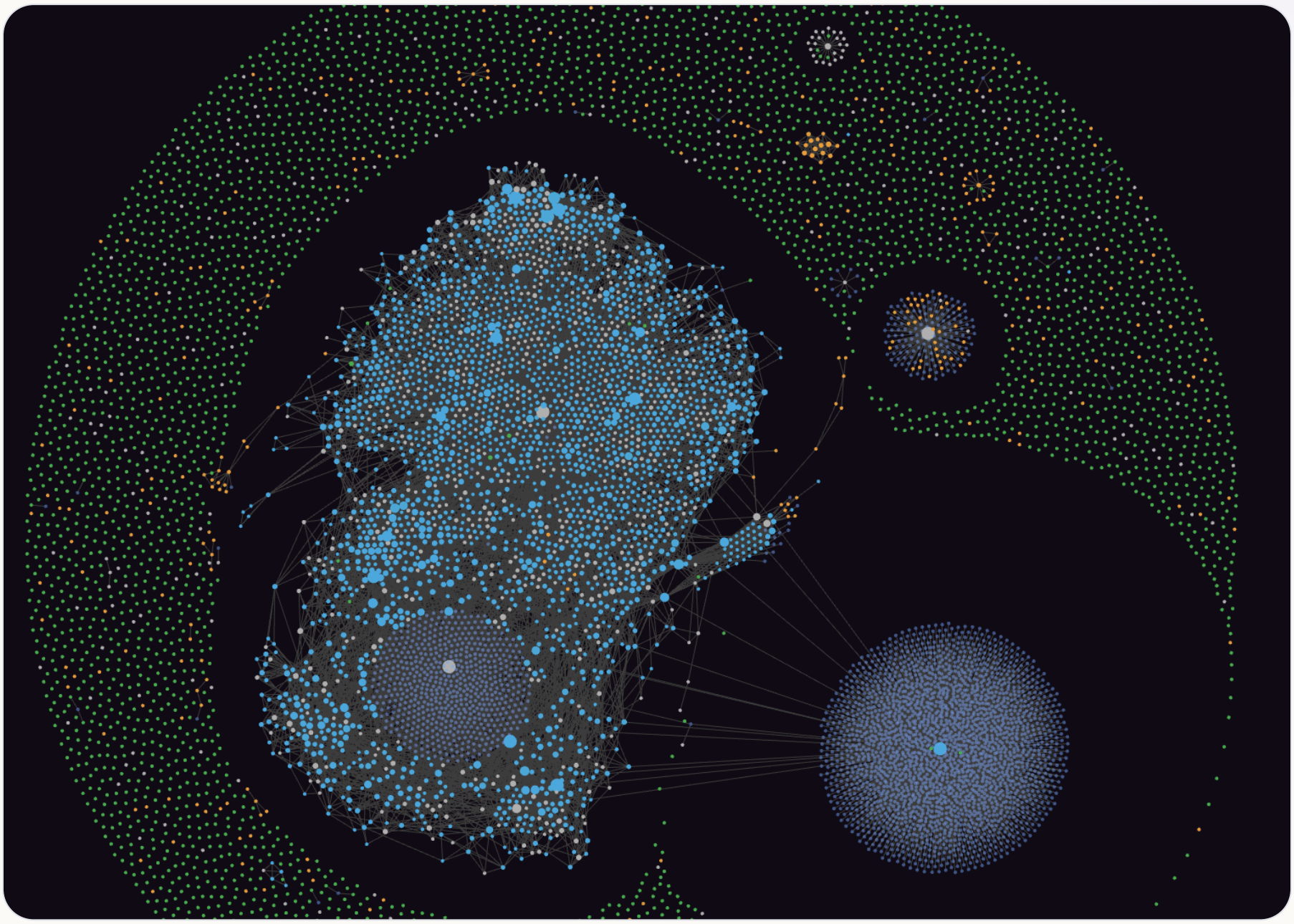
2 runs each. All 8 answers were right. The wiki was a few seconds faster.

Karpathy: it "works surprisingly well at moderate scale (~100 sources, ~hundreds of pages)".

Start with auto memory. Add the wiki when your notes grow.

MY OWN SETUP

# My second brain, as a graph.



Every dot is a note or a file. Every line is a link.

→ Memory index: just over 100 lines

→ Wiki: 2,300+ notes since 23 May

→ Every night at 04:30, a job adds new notes

FREE FILES

# Get the cheat sheet and the wiki rules. Free.

→ Auto memory and the wiki, side by side

→ The 19-line CLAUDE.md for the wiki

→ Templates for the index and a page

→ 16 made-up client notes, to test on

On my profile, under Featured: AI Starter Kit, step 16.
Save this post.

**Tomorrow: GitHub, your real undo button.**